SORTEE ADVOCACY COMMITTEE

SORTEE HACKATHON 2026

Data & code archiving in society journals

How well are ecology and evolution society journals sharing the data and code behind their articles?

Tuesday 13 October 2026 · 09:00–10:25 UTC

WHY

Journals ask for data and code. Is it working?

Many ecology and evolution society journals now **mandate or encourage** authors to share the data and code with their published articles, and some have **Data Editors** who check the quality of data and code.

But how well that works in practice varies. We will measure whether shared data and code are **archived, accessible, licensed and documented**.

The idea is to write a manuscript on the state of data and code archiving in society journals.

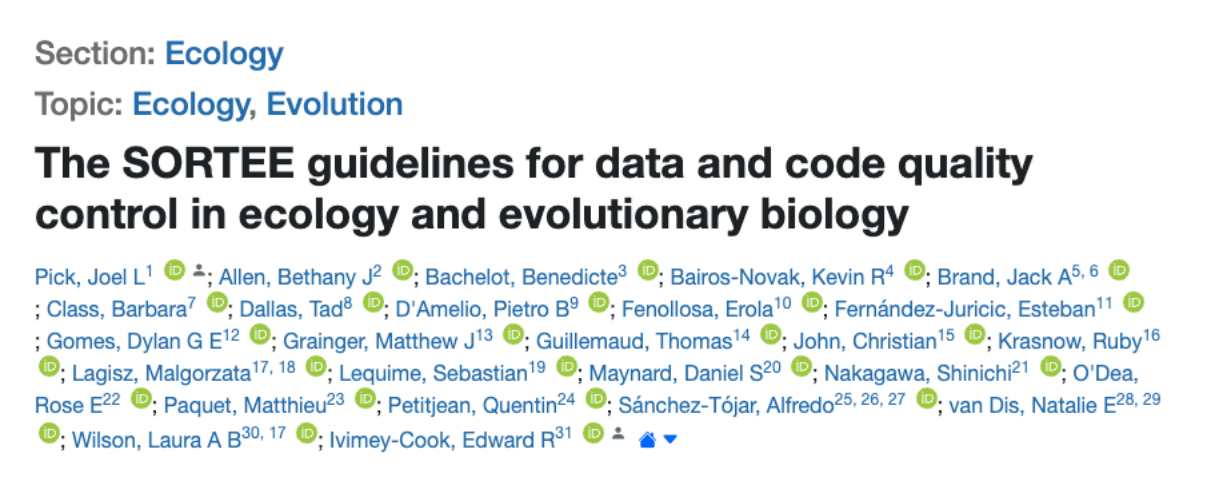
We want to test how journal policy and data editor presence influence data and code availability and sharing quality.

WHAT

What were going to do in this hackathon

Why societies? Researchers value these journals, and we expect them to broadly reflect the general state of EcoEvo.

Pre-registered protocol where we assess the papers following the SORTEE Data and Code Quality Control Guidelines.



Section: Ecology

Topic: Ecology, Evolution

The SORTEE guidelines for data and code quality control in ecology and evolutionary biology

Pick, Joel L[1]; Allen, Bethany J[2]; Bachelot, Benedicte[3]; Bairos-Novak, Kevin R[4]; Brand, Jack A[5, 6]; Class, Barbara[7]; Dallas, Tad[8]; D'Amelio, Pietro B[9]; Fenollosa, Erola[10]; Fernández-Juricic, Esteban[11]; Gomes, Dylan G E[12]; Grainger, Matthew J[13]; Guillemaud, Thomas[14]; John, Christian[15]; Krasnow, Ruby[16]; Lagisz, Malgorzata[17, 18]; Lequime, Sebastian[19]; Maynard, Daniel S[20]; Nakagawa, Shinichi[21]; O'Dea, Rose E[22]; Paquet, Matthieu[23]; Petitjean, Quentin[24]; Sánchez-Tójar, Alfredo[25, 26, 27]; van Dis, Natalie E[28, 29]; Wilson, Laura A B[30, 17]; Ivimey-Cook, Edward R[31]

89

society journals

1,439

articles to assess, from 10,721 published Jan–Sep 2026

CREDIT

Contribution expectation

Everyone gets a folder of ~45 Papers (5 – 6 hours worth of work).

Following Dragon Kill Points

What you find	DKP	Time
Not expected to have data or code (e.g., a review)	0	—
No data or code found	1	5 min
Data or code repository	2	10 min
Data and code repositories	3	15 min

To be a co-author

1. Fill in the Expression of Interest form
2. Gain 60 DKP of good-quality extractions
3. Read and approve the final manuscript

Different papers will have different amounts of things to extract – which we can't tell in advance (and is randomly assigned). **You won't necessarily have to do all 45. But please let us know when you have finished.**

DKPs allow us to fairly assign contribution.

HOW

What to do

1

Get your articles

Fill in the **Expression of Interest form** to get your file of articles to check.

2

Fill out the form

Fill out the extraction form for each article. Please do these in order ☺

3

Find the links

Search the article for "data" and "code"; check the availability statement.

4

Assess each repository

Permanent ID, licence, downloadable, README, file and variable descriptions, software versions.

Assess what is there, not what should be there. Don't run code or contact authors.

Work independently: about 25% of articles are extracted twice to check repeatability.

Every question is explained in the FAQ & guide

KEY INFO

Dates, links and who to ask

Tue 13 October, 09:00–10:25 UTC
Hackathon

13 October – 1 December
Seven weeks to finish your extraction

Tue 1 December
Data extraction closes

FAQ & guide: eivimeycook.github.io/Data-Code_Society

Links: Pre-registration · Expression of Interest form · Expression of Interest sheet · Extraction form · Article issue form · List of articles with issues · Article Sets

Questions: Zoom chat or Slack, or email Ed Ivimey-Cook (e.ivimeycook@gmail.com) or Joel Pick (joel.l.pick@gmail.com)

Be kind: we follow the SORTEE Code of Conduct